MacroLens Daily Brief — July 15, 2026

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Top Headlines

1. **US says it has begun new wave of strikes on Iran - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-15 10:47
   The US launched a new wave of strikes on Iran, escalating military conflict in the Middle East.

2. **US strikes Iran again as Tehran warns of 'existential war' with America - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-15 04:57
   Iran warned of an 'existential war' with America following renewed US strikes, heightening geopolitical risk.

3. **EXCLUSIVE: US strikes on Iran strengthen Trump's options for new escalation, officials say - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-15 18:56
   US strikes on Iran are strengthening options for further escalation, according to officials, signaling potential for sustained conflict.

4. **Some ships refusing US-military guided Hormuz transits after attacks, sources say - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-15 20:14
   Some ships are refusing US-military guided transits through the Strait of Hormuz after attacks, threatening oil supply routes.

5. **White House weighs extending Jones Act waivers as Iran conflict raises price concerns - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-15 16:50
   The White House is considering extending Jones Act waivers as the Iran conflict raises fuel price concerns.

6. **Most Gulf markets subdued as US-Iran tensions escalate - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-15 14:04
   Most Gulf markets were subdued as US-Iran tensions escalated, reflecting risk-off sentiment in regional equities.

7. **Stocks rise after soft US inflation reading with Middle East in focus - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-15 01:48

Stocks rose after a soft US inflation reading, with markets also monitoring Middle East conflict for broader risk.

8. **Oil prices sink, shrugging off renewed Middle East fighting - Reuters**
   Reuters — 2026-07-15 01:06
   Oil prices sank despite renewed Middle East fighting, indicating traders are pricing in limited supply disruption.

9. **Kalshi traders see gas prices crossing $4 by end of July**
   CNBC — 2026-07-15 21:11
   Kalshi traders see a 90% chance US gas prices exceed $4 by end of July, up from 56%, as US strikes on Iran resume and oil prices rise for three straight days.

10. **US drivers may soon see pump prices climb back up to $4 - Reuters**
    Reuters — 2026-07-14 22:05
    US drivers may soon see pump prices climb back to $4, driven by escalating US-Iran conflict and rising oil prices.

Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	751.83	+0.36%	neutral
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	719.69	+1.12%	bullish
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	524.69	+0.04%	neutral
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	294.51	+0.35%	neutral
XLK	Technology ETF	183.62	+1.29%	bullish
XLF	Financials ETF	56.18	+0.20%	neutral
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	81.93	+0.17%	neutral
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	93.55	+0.28%	neutral
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	84.08	+0.13%	neutral
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	107.21	+0.23%	neutral
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	79.68	+0.20%	neutral

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	372.15	+1.37%	bullish
SLV	Silver ETF	53.17	+1.94%	bullish
USO	Oil ETF	120.17	+2.02%	bullish
UNG	Natural Gas ETF	10.52	+1.45%	bullish
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	28.39	-0.39%	neutral
FXE	Euro ETF	105.39	+0.36%	neutral
FXY	Japanese Yen ETF	56.57	+0.19%	neutral
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	64956.11	+4.37%	bullish
ETH-USD	Ethereum	1889.48	+6.54%	bullish

Major Anomalies

ETH-USD — Ethereum `+6.54%`

Cause: Ethereum surged alongside Bitcoin, driven by broader crypto market momentum and positive tech news, with additional support from Ethereum network upgrades and DeFi activity.

Forward Impact: Ethereum's price could see further gains if risk appetite persists and network fundamentals improve, but it remains sensitive to crypto market trends and regulatory developments.

BTC-USD — Bitcoin `+4.37%`

Cause: Bitcoin rallied amid positive sentiment from Apple's AI breakthrough in China, which boosted tech and risk assets, and as crypto markets reacted to geopolitical uncertainty as a hedge.

Forward Impact: Bitcoin may continue to benefit from risk-on sentiment and safe-haven demand, but volatility remains high due to macro and regulatory factors.

USO — Oil ETF `+2.02%`

Cause: Oil prices rose due to heightened geopolitical tensions in the Middle East, including Iran conflict escalation and threats to Hormuz transits, raising supply disruption fears.

Forward Impact: Continued geopolitical risks and potential Jones Act waiver extensions could keep oil prices elevated, but demand concerns may limit upside.

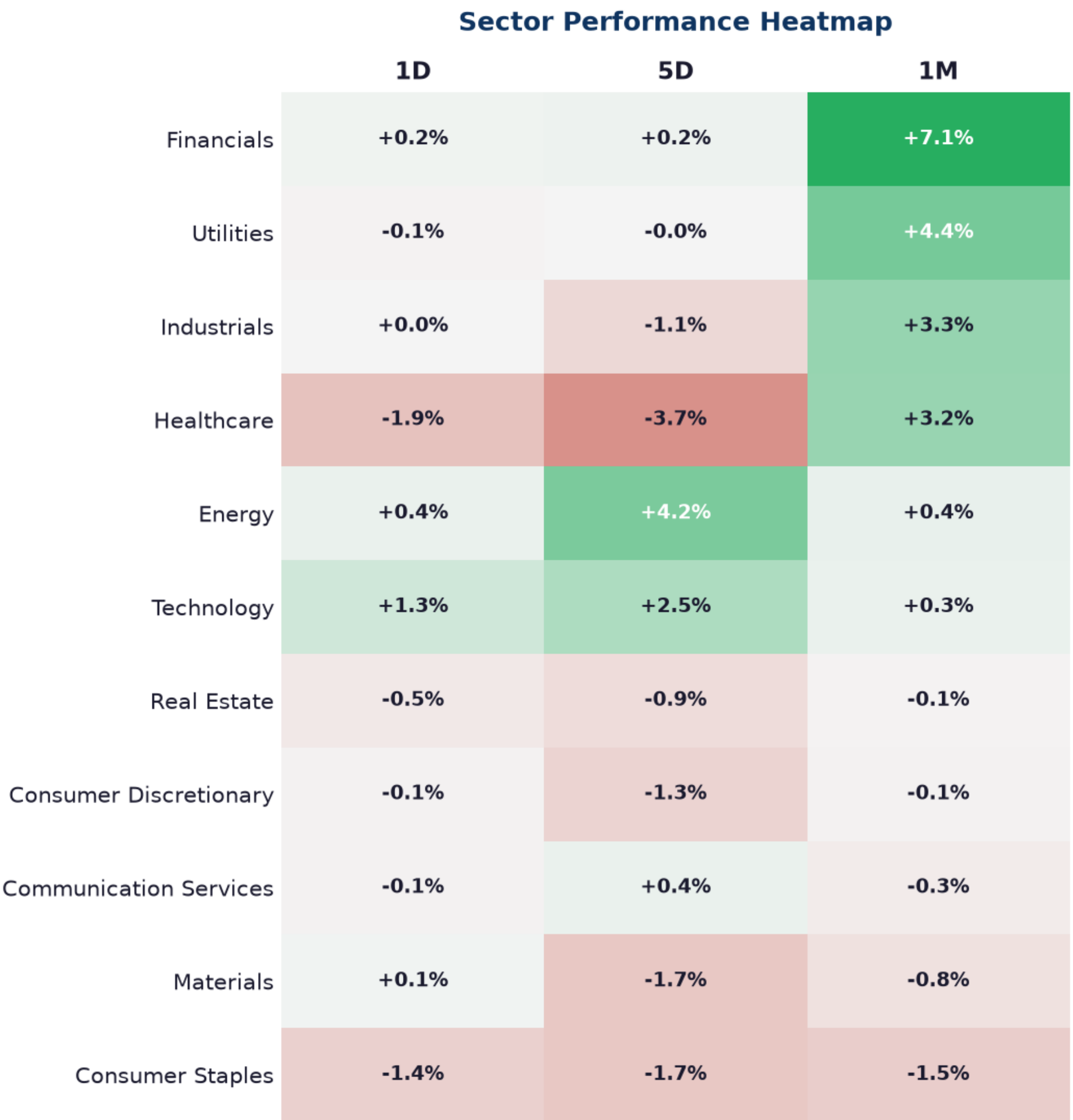
Macro Data Releases — Today

[Calendar error: 403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?from=2026-07-15&to=2026-07-23&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong]

Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

No upcoming macro events in the next 7 days.

Sector Heat Map



Hot Now

- **Financials** — Strong 1m performance and positive across all timeframes
- **Energy** — Strong 5d momentum and positive 1d
- **Technology** — Strong 1d and 5d momentum despite flat 1m

Cold but Worth Watching

- **Healthcare** — Sharp 1d and 5d decline but positive 1m, potential mean-reversion
- **Consumer Staples** — Consistent negative across timeframes, oversold conditions

Cyclical sectors like Financials and Energy lead on strong economic data, while defensive sectors lag, suggesting risk-on sentiment.

Daily Conclusion

Risk-on rotation accelerates as geopolitical escalation in Iran drives energy and crypto spikes, while defensive sectors like Healthcare and Consumer Staples lag.

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